SESSION 02 · CLASS EXERCISE · PAIRS OR THREES

FAILURE OR CHAOS?

NAMES _____

Read each case. Write F for failure or C for chaos. For each chaos case, write which of the four causes it is.

CASE	WHAT HAPPENED	F OR C	CAUSE OF CHAOS
A	A tutor gives ten families a free first lesson to see if they will book a second. Two book. She writes down which families booked, and why.		
B	A tailor is busier every month. Every month there is less cash in the drawer. Nobody knows why.		
C	Three friends run a delivery service. Each one thinks another one orders the boxes. One morning there are no boxes.		
D	A bakery rents a stand at a weekend fair, with a limit of 500 units of money set in advance. Sales cover half. The owner learns that fair visitors want snacks, not whole loaves.		
E	Two partners run a juice stand. One wants to grow fast. The other wants to stay small. Neither says so. They argue about every purchase.		
F	A clothing seller opens an online shop. Orders come in, but nobody planned how returns work. Angry customers leave bad reviews.		
G	A car wash offers a monthly plan to 20 customers for one month. Only 5 renew. The owner asks why and learns they wanted it only in summer.		
H	A café tries opening at 6 a.m. for two weeks. Before it starts, the owner writes: stop if fewer than ten customers come each morning. Four come. The café stops.		

UNKNOWN NUMBERS
Nobody knows the real numbers.

UNCLEAR DECISIONS
Nobody knows who decides.

HIDDEN DISAGREEMENTS
People disagree and do not say it.

A MISSED PART
One of the 19 parts of a business nobody watched.

A FAILURE YOU CAN LEARN FROM PASSES THREE TESTS

You planned it. You could afford it. It showed you which belief was wrong.

Source: Sternberg (2026), Part 1. The eight cases are written for this class.

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SESSION 02 · CLASS EXERCISE

TURN CHAOS INTO A TEST

CHOOSE TWO CHAOS CASES

TEST 1 · CASE ___

WE BELIEVE…

WE TEST IT BY…

WE SPEND NO MORE THAN…
(UNITS OF MONEY)

WE WILL KNOW BY… (DATE)

TEST 2 · CASE ___

WE BELIEVE…

WE TEST IT BY…

WE SPEND NO MORE THAN…
(UNITS OF MONEY)

WE WILL KNOW BY… (DATE)

GROUP WORK · TEAMS OF 4 OR 5

YOUR TEAM

ROLES

MAP KEEPER _____

CHAOS-LOG KEEPER _____

NUMBERS KEEPER _____

DEADLINE KEEPER _____

SPEAKER _____

PROBLEM MAP HEADER

THE PROBLEM, IN ONE SENTENCE _____

_____

WHERE AND WHEN YOU SAW IT _____

CHAOS LOG · ENTRY 1

WHAT HAPPENED? _____

FAILURE OR CHAOS? _____

WHAT WILL WE DO? _____

Source: Sternberg (2026), Parts 1 and 5.

Sternberg, M. (2026). *Hunger, curiosity & chaos: 101 ways entrepreneurs think*. Son of a Botanist Productions. https://starvechaos.com

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